

If this is done via email or Git, you'll have to know a bit more. The project you are trying to contribute to is most likely using gettext for localisation. As a translator, the only part you must care about this infrastructure is the `.po` files, which contain translations for all the strings in a particular locale (a language-region combo). You either edit the `.po` file that is already provided, or start a new one by copying the PO template for the project (the template usually has a `.pot` extension).

Although PO files are textual and can be edited manually, the task is error-prone and best handled using an application like Gtranslator or Poedit. Online platforms do let you upload and edit PO files even though the project is not present on them.

By the way, if you are looking for translation-related stuff on project pages, keep an eye out for `l10n` and `i18n`. They stand for localisation (the act of translating something to a local language and conventions) and internationalisation (the act of making a program ready for localisation).

Mindful contribution

We have already discussed why personal projects are important and how too many typo fixes can be annoying. What else must we be careful about?

For one, don't act like a project is a public property. If something is free/open

source it doesn't mean there isn't a private owner. The upstream owners are free to do whatever they want to the project, except maybe make your contributions proprietary. Even that is possible if the project is under permissive free software licences like the MIT licence.

Don't contribute for anything other than fun. Free software can make money, but one usually doesn't do that when volunteering for others' projects.

Finally, don't pay for contributing to a project. Although I'm not aware of any such scams, that could be a possibility in an age where your GitHub profile can give you a career boost. **END!** 

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OSFY Magazine Attractions During 2024-25

Month	Theme
March 2024	Gen AI, Deep learning and Machine Learning
April 2024	Open Source Programming (Languages and tools)
May 2024	Blockchain and Open Source
June 2024	Security, Network Management and Monitoring
July 2024	All About Data Management (Database management, Optimisation, Big Data, Data analysis, etc)
August 2024	Mobile/Web App Development, Optimisation and Security
September 2024	DevOps Special
October 2024	Cloud Special: Everything from management to implementation
November 2024	Containers and Managing Containers
December 2024	Open Source and Quantum Computing
January 2025	Open Source and IoT and Edge
February 2025	Open Source on Windows and Best in the world of Open Source (Tools and Services)